NITI AAYOG

2015 CABINET RESOLUTION, EXECUTIVE → FOUNDATIONAL OBJECTIVES, PRINCIPLES AND → COMPOSITION: POLITICAL LEADERSHIP, EXPERT → GOVERNING COUNCIL, REGIONAL COUNCILS → COMPETITIVE FEDERALISM, DASHBOARDS AND → ASPIRATIONAL INITIATIVES, SDG LOCALISATION

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure; the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

● PRIMARY CORE FLOW ● SUBORDINATE EXTRA ● APPROVAL / REVIEW

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • active generation g2 repaired in place for answer-line and visual-boundary quality • all prior artifacts unchanged

00

STAGE 00 2015 CABINET RESOLUTION, EXECUTIVE STATUS AND PLANNING COMMISSION TRANSITION

2015 CABINET RESOLUTION, EXECUTIVE STATUS AND PLANNING COMMISSION TRANSITION · ROOT PROBLEM · HOW CAN NATIONAL DEVELOPMENT STRATEGY COORDINATE UNION, STATES AND · 1 JANUARY 2015 CABINET RESOLUTION CREATES NATIONAL INSTITUTION FOR · LEGAL STATUS EXECUTIVE · PLANNING COMMISSION MODEL · NITI POLICY PLATFORM · FIVE-YEAR PLANS ENDED; PLAN/NON-PLAN BUDGET CLASSIFICATION ENDED THROUGH LATER

ROOT PROBLEM → How can national development strategy coordinate Union, States and local needs without reviving central command → 1 JANUARY 2015 CABINET RESOLUTION creates National Institution for Transforming India, NITI Aayog. → LEGAL STATUS executive → Planning Commission model → NITI policy platform.

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE
- ROOT PROBLEM
- How can national development strategy coordinate Union, States and local needs without reviving central command planning?

POWER / PROCEDURE
- 1 JANUARY 2015 CABINET RESOLUTION creates National Institution for Transforming India, NITI Aayog.
- LEGAL STATUS executive

CHECK / LIMIT
- Planning Commission model → NITI policy platform.
- Five-Year Plans ended; plan/non-plan budget classification ended through later budget reform.

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT
- CONTINUITY both institutions arose through Union executive resolutions.
- LIMIT replacement did not transfer Article 280, budget, legislative or taxing powers to NITI.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: NITI Aayog replaced the Planning Commission's planning role without inheriting plan-allocation power or displacing the constitutionally separate Finance Commission.

01

STAGE 01 FOUNDATIONAL OBJECTIVES, PRINCIPLES AND THE TEAM INDIA-KNOWLEDGE DUAL ROLE

FOUNDATIONAL OBJECTIVES, PRINCIPLES AND THE TEAM INDIA-KNOWLEDGE DUAL ROLE · TEAM INDIA ROLE SHARED NATIONAL VISION WITH ACTIVE STATE · COOPERATIVE FEDERAL DIALOGUE · POLICY COORDINATION. · KNOWLEDGE AND INNOVATION ROLE LONG-TERM STRATEGY · BEST PRACTICE · TECHNOLOGY CAPACITY SUPPORT · MONITORING AND FEEDBACK.

TEAM INDIA ROLE shared national vision with active State participation

cooperative federal dialogue → policy coordination. → KNOWLEDGE AND INNOVATION ROLE long-term strategy → best practice

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE
- TEAM INDIA ROLE shared national vision with active State participation
- cooperative federal dialogue → policy coordination.
- KNOWLEDGE AND INNOVATION ROLE long-term strategy

POWER / PROCEDURE
- best practice
- technology capacity support
- monitoring and feedback.

CHECK / LIMIT
- FOUNDATIONAL PRINCIPLES bottom-up planning
- inclusion of vulnerable sections village-to-national aggregation
- outcome orientation.

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT
- POLICY CHAIN diagnose problem → consult → design option → advise competent government
- implement through law, budget and administration → evaluate → revise.
- LIMIT an official objective describes mandate; it does not prove achievement or create coercive power.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: NITI Aayog integrates policy advice, cooperative federal consultation and programme monitoring, but lacks command authority over every ministry or State.

02

STAGE 02 COMPOSITION: POLITICAL LEADERSHIP, EXPERT CAPACITY AND NOTIFICATION-SENSITIVE CATEGORIES

POLITICAL LEADERSHIP, EXPERT CAPACITY AND NOTIFICATION-SENSITIVE CATEGORIES · PRIME MINISTER. · FEDERAL FORUM · GOVERNING COUNCIL INCLUDES CHIEF MINISTERS AND RELEVANT UNION TERRITORY · EXECUTIVE-EXPERT SIDE · FULL-TIME MEMBERS · PART-TIME MEMBERS FROM INSTITUTIONS EX-OFFICIO UNION MINISTERS · SPECIAL INVITEES

Prime Minister.

FEDERAL FORUM → Governing Council includes Chief Ministers and relevant Union Territory leadership. → EXECUTIVE-EXPERT SIDE

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE
- Prime Minister.
- FEDERAL FORUM
- Governing Council includes Chief Ministers and relevant Union Territory leadership.

POWER / PROCEDURE
- EXECUTIVE-EXPERT SIDE
- full-time members
- part-time members from institutions ex-officio Union Ministers

CHECK / LIMIT
- special invitees
- FOUNDATIONAL LIMITS part-time members: maximum two
- ex-officio members: maximum four.

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT
- NOTIFICATION CONTROL names, portfolios, invitees and exact composition may be reconstituted.
- Use the current official notification only when a dated fact is required.
- CEO or Vice-Chairperson status is executive design, not constitutional tenure.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: NITI Aayog's composition can be revised by executive notification, allowing adaptable expertise but making membership institutionally volatile.

03

STAGE 03 GOVERNING COUNCIL, REGIONAL COUNCILS AND COOPERATIVE FEDERAL PROCESS

GOVERNING COUNCIL, REGIONAL COUNCILS AND COOPERATIVE FEDERAL PROCESS · GOVERNING COUNCIL CONTINUING DEVELOPMENT-POLICY FORUM CHAIRED BY PRIME MINISTER · STATE AND UNION TERRITORY LEADERS DELIBERATE ON SHARED PRIORITIES. · REGIONAL COUNCILS TEMPORARY ISSUE-SPECIFIC GROUPS FOR MORE THAN ONE · CHAIRED OR CONVENED UNDER THE RESOLUTION'S EXECUTIVE DESIGN. · COOPERATIVE FEDERALISM CONSULTATION + AGENDA SHARING + JOINT DIAGNOSIS · STATE SUPPORT · STATE SUPPORT MISSION AND STATE INSTITUTIONS FOR TRANSFORMATION OFFER

GOVERNING COUNCIL continuing development-policy forum chaired by Prime Minister

State and Union Territory leaders deliberate on shared priorities. → REGIONAL COUNCILS temporary issue-specific groups for more than one State or a region → chaired or convened under the resolution's executive design.

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE
- GOVERNING COUNCIL continuing development-policy forum chaired by Prime Minister
- State and Union Territory leaders deliberate on shared priorities.
- REGIONAL COUNCILS temporary issue-specific groups for more than one State or a region

POWER / PROCEDURE
- chaired or convened under the resolution's executive design.
- COOPERATIVE FEDERALISM consultation + agenda sharing + joint diagnosis + peer learning + follow-up.
- STATE SUPPORT

CHECK / LIMIT
- State Support Mission and State Institutions for Transformation offer capacity and policy-system assistance; uptake varies.
- BOTTOM-UP CLAIM village plans should aggregate upward, but local planning depends on State law and capacity.
- Council consensus is political coordination, not a second chamber or binding intergovernmental law.

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT
- chaired or convened under the resolution's executive design.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: The Governing Council creates a forum for Union-State policy coordination, but its consensus must still be implemented by the competent legal and budgetary authorities.

04

STAGE 04 COMPETITIVE FEDERALISM, DASHBOARDS AND THE EVIDENCE-TO-ACTION MECHANISM

COMPETITIVE FEDERALISM, DASHBOARDS AND THE EVIDENCE-TO-ACTION MECHANISM · COMPETITIVE FEDERALISM COMMON INDICATORS · COMPARABLE PERFORMANCE · PUBLIC RANKING OR DELTA · PEER PRESSURE · ADMINISTRATIVE ATTENTION · CORRECTIVE ACTION. · DATA-TO-POLICY LOOP DEFINE OUTCOME

COMPETITIVE FEDERALISM common indicators → comparable performance → public ranking or delta → peer pressure → administrative attention → corrective action. → DATA-TO-POLICY LOOP define outcome → select indicator → establish baseline → collect and verify → compare → diagnose cause → intervene → reassess. → POTENTIAL GAIN visibility, learning, priority focus and faster feedback without command power.

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE
- COMPETITIVE FEDERALISM common indicators → comparable performance → public ranking or delta
- peer pressure → administrative attention → corrective action.
- DATA-TO-POLICY LOOP define outcome → select indicator → establish baseline → collect and verify

POWER / PROCEDURE
- compare → diagnose cause → intervene → reassess.
- POTENTIAL GAIN visibility, learning, priority focus and faster feedback without command power.
- Goodhart's law

CHECK / LIMIT
- data lag
- unequal capacity composite-index opacity
- correlation mistaken for causation.

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT
- SAFE USE publish method and uncertainty; pair rank with levels, change and field evidence.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Competitive-federal rankings can spur improvement, but reveal neither every welfare dimension nor the absolute quality of public services.

05

STAGE 05 ASPIRATIONAL INITIATIVES, SDG LOCALISATION, DMEO AND INNOVATION WITHIN BOUNDS

ASPIRATIONAL INITIATIVES, SDG LOCALISATION, DMEO AND INNOVATION WITHIN BOUNDS · ASPIRATIONAL DISTRICTS · BLOCKS CONVERGENCE + COLLABORATION + COMPETITION · INDICATOR TRACKING AND DELTA IMPROVEMENT · IMPLEMENTATION REMAINS WITH GOVERNMENTS AND FIELD AGENCIES. · SDG LOCALISATION NATIONAL GOALS · INDICATOR FRAMEWORK · STATE AND LOCAL COMPARISON

ASPIRATIONAL DISTRICTS / BLOCKS convergence + collaboration + competition

indicator tracking and delta improvement → implementation remains with governments and field agencies. → SDG LOCALISATION national goals → indicator framework → State and local comparison

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE
- ASPIRATIONAL DISTRICTS / BLOCKS convergence + collaboration + competition
- indicator tracking and delta improvement
- implementation remains with governments and field agencies.

POWER / PROCEDURE
- SDG LOCALISATION national goals → indicator framework → State and local comparison
- policy attention; index publication is not constitutional power.
- DMEO monitoring and evaluation support → evidence on design, process and outcomes.

CHECK / LIMIT
- ATAL INNOVATION MISSION executive programme under NITI; current architecture depends on Cabinet and programme controls.
- NITI may coordinate, study, rank and recommend.
- It does not legislate, appropriate money or guarantee district outcomes.

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT
- SDG LOCALISATION national goals → indicator framework → State and local comparison

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: The Aspirational Districts Programme uses convergence, collaboration and competition to reward incremental improvement, but dashboard quality and unmeasured needs limit what rankings prove.

06

STAGE 06 NITI, PLANNING COMMISSION, FINANCE COMMISSION AND GST COUNCIL COMPARED

NITI, PLANNING COMMISSION, FINANCE COMMISSION AND GST COUNCIL COMPARED · NITI AAYOG · 2015 EXECUTIVE RESOLUTION · STRATEGY, DIALOGUE, KNOWLEDGE AND MONITORING · NO TRANSFER AWARD. · PLANNING COMMISSION · 1950 EXECUTIVE RESOLUTION · FIVE-YEAR PLANS AND PLAN-RESOURCE INFLUENCE

2015 executive resolution	strategy, dialogue, knowledge and monitoring	no transfer award.
1950 executive resolution	Five-Year Plans and plan-resource influence	abolished.
Article 280	periodic expert recommendations on tax distribution and grants.	
Article 279A	continuing Union-State forum for GST recommendations.	
Article 263 route	intergovernmental coordination and advice.	
Articles 243I and 243Y	State-local fiscal recommendations.	

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE
- NITI AAYOG
- 2015 executive resolution
- strategy, dialogue, knowledge and monitoring
- no transfer award.
- PLANNING COMMISSION

POWER / PROCEDURE
- 1950 executive resolution
- Five-Year Plans and plan-resource influence
- FINANCE COMMISSION
- Article 280
- periodic expert recommendations on tax distribution and grants.

CHECK / LIMIT
- GST COUNCIL
- Article 279A
- continuing Union-State forum for GST recommendations.
- INTER-STATE COUNCIL
- Article 263 route

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT
- intergovernmental coordination and advice.
- STATE FINANCE COMMISSION
- Articles 243I and 243Y
- State-local fiscal recommendations.
- TRAP strategy, fiscal distribution, tax coordination and intergovernmental consultation are distinct.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: NITI may recommend better local data, planning and outcomes, but fiscal empowerment of local bodies requires State action, SFC processes, legislative rules and actual transfer of funds/functions.

07

STAGE 07 STRENGTHS, ACCOUNTABILITY DEFICITS, REFORM AND THE DATED FEDERAL ANCHOR

STRENGTHS, ACCOUNTABILITY DEFICITS, REFORM AND THE DATED FEDERAL ANCHOR · STRENGTHS FLEXIBILITY · HIGH-LEVEL CONVENING · CROSS-SECTOR KNOWLEDGE · STATE DIALOGUE · RAPID POLICY STUDIES · MONITORING AND INNOVATION. · LIMITS NON-BINDING ADVICE

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE
- STRENGTHS flexibility
- high-level convening
- cross-sector knowledge
- State dialogue
- rapid policy studies

POWER / PROCEDURE
- monitoring and innovation.
- LIMITS non-binding advice
- central agenda power
- weak legislative reporting data quality
- uncertain follow-through

CHECK / LIMIT
- capacity asymmetry.
- REFORM publish consultation records and evaluation methods
- independent data audit → State agenda windows
- action-taken tracking → parliamentary scrutiny without statutory rigidity.
- DATED ANCHOR

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT
- 11th Governing Council, 11 June 2026
- "Inclusive Human Development for Viksit Bharat@2047."
- CAUTION meeting theme proves agenda and convening, not implementation success or a justiciable target.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: NITI's comparative space is broader policy strategy and evidence, while the Finance Commission and GST Council operate in constitutionally specified fiscal domains.

08

STAGE 08 PYQ ROUTES, CLOSE-OPTION TRAPS AND QUALIFIED POLICY-PLATFORM SYNTHESIS

PYQ ROUTES, CLOSE-OPTION TRAPS AND QUALIFIED POLICY-PLATFORM SYNTHESIS · PYQ ROUTES · 2018 GS-III · PRINCIPLES OF NITI VERSUS PLANNING COMMISSION. · 2019 PRELIMS · ATAL INNOVATION MISSION INSTITUTIONAL LOCATION. · PRELIMS FIREWALL EXECUTIVE · NO ARTICLE 280 ALLOCATION

PYQ ROUTES → 2018 GS-III — principles of NITI versus Planning Commission. → 2019 Prelims — Atal Innovation Mission institutional location. → PRELIMS FIREWALL executive != unconstitutional → no Article 280 allocation

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE
- PYQ ROUTES
- 2018 GS-III — principles of NITI versus Planning Commission.
- 2019 Prelims — Atal Innovation Mission institutional location.
- PRELIMS FIREWALL executive != unconstitutional

POWER / PROCEDURE
- no Article 280 allocation
- Governing Council != legislature
- Regional Council != Zonal Council index != binding power
- plan/non-plan abolition != NITI decree.

CHECK / LIMIT
- MAINS SPINE
- 2015 origin → legal status → objectives → composition
- federal mechanism → evidence tools → comparison
- strength and deficit → accountable reform.

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT
- QUALIFIED VERDICT
- NITI is influential when credible evidence, State ownership and competent implementation converge
- without them, soft coordination cannot substitute for law, finance or administrative capacity.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Ending Five-Year Plans and ending plan/non-plan classification both weakened the older institutional vocabulary, but one concerned planning horizons while the other concerned budget classification.

E

EXTRA SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENT · PART A — ESTABLISHMENT · PART B — COMPOSITION · PART C — OBJECTIVES & FUNCTIONS · PART D — PLANNING COMMISSION VS NITI AAYOG (COMPARE) · INDIA'S PREMIER POLICY "THINK TANK" — PROVIDES DIRECTIONAL &. · REPLACES THE PLANNING COMMISSION'S ONE-WAY, TOP-DOWN, COMMAND-AND-CONTROL FLOW WITH · TWO HUBS

OPTIONAL DOCTRINE / CASE
- PART A — ESTABLISHMENT
- PART B — COMPOSITION
- PART C — OBJECTIVES & FUNCTIONS
- PART D — PLANNING COMMISSION vs NITI AAYOG (compare)

ADVANCED LIMIT
- India's premier policy "Think Tank" — provides directional & policy inputs; a "Bharatiya approach to
- Replaces the Planning Commission's one-way, top-down, command-and-control flow with a bottom-up,
- Two hubs: Team India Hub (cooperative federalism + policy design) & Knowledge & Innovation Hub
- CAUTION: Key limitation: NITI Aayog only recommends — it has NO power to allocate funds (that power moved to

COMPARATIVE NUANCE
- NOT: NITI Aayog is a constitutional/statutory body → it is neither (executive resolution).
- NOT: NITI Aayog allocates funds to states → it is advisory only ; fund allocation is with the Finance
- NOT: The President is the chairperson → the Prime Minister .
- NOT: Governing Council excludes UT chiefs → includes CMs of UTs with legislatures + LGs of other UTs .

OPTIONAL STATUS — This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.

END OF MASTER CANVAS • poster embeds this exact master • tiled pages are overlapping crops of the same pixels